

At 47, I learned two very valuable lessons from this. One, I had left my investments in the hands of someone who was not a financial expert and should never do this again. Two, you can rebuild your investment nest even when you're older, it just takes a lot of work and smart financial service friends to help get you back on track. Ladies, put your own oxygen mask on first—every single day!

Whether it's a poor financial decision, an oversight, or an unplanned life transition like in Sheryl's case, things can happen that will throw you for a loop. However, I love to look at every single situation as a learning experience. I choose this approach because when I can assess what went wrong and how it went wrong, I can better determine the next best steps to take to achieve success in the future. So, let's talk about some of the most common mistakes investors make and how you can avoid them.

KEY INVESTING MISTAKES AND HOW TO AVOID THEM

Waiting to invest. When it comes to investing, time is your biggest asset and the best time to start investing is right now. By investing early on, you'll have a better chance of greater returns on your investments. Not only will you have more time to contribute to your investments; you will also have more time for your investments to grow and benefit from the “magic” of compounding.

Investing with emotion. Watching every dip and climb that happens in the stock market every day is a bad idea and will cause you unnecessary stress. Investing without any research because your best friend or family member recommended a particular investment is also a bad idea. Things like this are recipes for disaster. Why? Because investing requires you to be objective and put your emotions aside. You'll need to ask yourself questions like, Does this investment make sense? Do I understand it? What is the level of risk? What is the rate of return? How much time am I able to invest? When it comes to making investing decisions, it's important to set your emotions aside and make your decisions with a clear head and based on your long-term financial goals.